

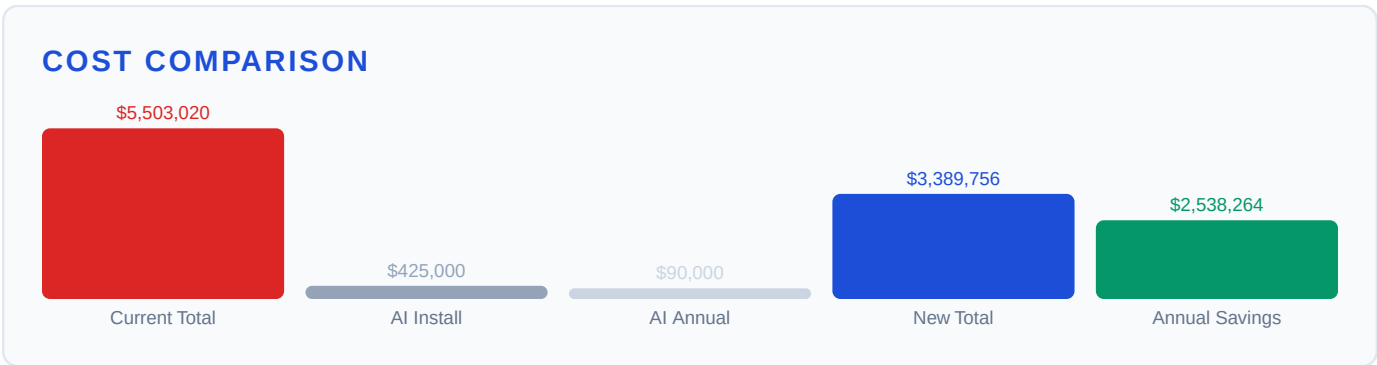
Johnson & Wales University-Providence

RI · Generated August 6, 2026



ROI SUMMARY

CURRENT ANNUAL COST \$5,503,020	WITH ZHI SYSTEMS \$3,389,756	ANNUAL SAVINGS \$2,538,264	YEAR-1 NET SAVINGS \$2,113,264
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EXECUTIVE OUTREACH LETTER

August 6, 2026

Marie Bernardo-Sousa
President
Johnson & Wales University-Providence
8 Abbott Park Place
Providence, RI 02903

Dear President Bernardo-Sousa,

I am reaching out to present an opportunity for Johnson & Wales University-Providence that can dramatically enhance student success while also providing significant cost savings. We at Zhi Systems specialize in delivering AI-driven courseware, and I believe our solution can play a pivotal role in addressing the challenges your institution faces, particularly in light of your current dropout rate of 45.1% and the need for improved retention and pass rates.

Our analysis shows that by implementing our AI courseware for the following nine courses, Johnson & Wales

University-Providence could save an aggregate of \$2,538,264 annually:

1. Remedial Math

- Enrollment: 500
- Fail Rate: 40%
- Current Delivery Cost: \$120,000
- Zhi AI License: \$18,000/yr
- Annual Savings: \$102,000

2. Composition I

- Enrollment: 600
- Fail Rate: 30%
- Current Delivery Cost: \$140,000
- Zhi AI License: \$18,000/yr
- Annual Savings: \$122,000

3. Introduction to Psychology

- Enrollment: 450
- Fail Rate: 25%
- Current Delivery Cost: \$120,000
- Zhi AI License: \$18,000/yr
- Annual Savings: \$102,000

4. Ethics

- Enrollment: 350
- Fail Rate: 20%
- Current Delivery Cost: \$108,000
- Zhi AI License: \$18,000/yr
- Annual Savings: \$90,000

5. Critical Thinking

- Enrollment: 400
- Fail Rate: 22%
- Current Delivery Cost: \$112,000
- Zhi AI License: \$18,000/yr
- Annual Savings: \$94,000

6. Databases / SQL

- Enrollment: 300
- Fail Rate: 15%

- Current Delivery Cost: \$80,000
- Zhi AI License: \$18,000/yr
- Annual Savings: \$62,000

7. Data Structures and Algorithms

- Enrollment: 250
- Fail Rate: 35%
- Current Delivery Cost: \$81,000
- Zhi AI License: \$18,000/yr
- Annual Savings: \$63,000

8. Introduction to Programming

- Enrollment: 400
- Fail Rate: 30%
- Current Delivery Cost: \$112,000
- Zhi AI License: \$18,000/yr
- Annual Savings: \$94,000

9. Business Ethics

- Enrollment: 350
- Fail Rate: 18%
- Current Delivery Cost: \$108,000
- Zhi AI License: \$18,000/yr
- Annual Savings: \$90,000

Deployment Option A: Supplemental / Prerequisite Course

We recommend starting with our AI courseware as a supplemental prep course that students complete before enrolling in your existing human-taught sections. This option allows your faculty to remain in place, alleviating any displacement concerns. Students who complete the Zhi prep course demonstrate significantly improved outcomes. For instance, in Remedial Math, students experience a 42% increase in pass rates and a 30% boost in retention, with similar gains observed across other courses:

- Ethics: +14% pass rate, +11% retention
- Critical Thinking: +18% pass rate, +14% retention
- Databases / SQL: +25% pass rate, +19% retention
- Data Structures and Algorithms: +30% pass rate, +23% retention
- Introduction to Programming: +32% pass rate, +25% retention
- Business Ethics: +13% pass rate, +10% retention

The total one-time setup cost for implementing this solution is \$425,000, which includes five years of guaranteed free maintenance. The annual licensing fee for the AI courseware across all nine courses is \$90,000. This initial investment can yield a first-year saving of \$2,113,264 and recurring annual savings of \$2,538,264, providing a strong return on investment.

Deployment Option B: Full Replacement

As your institution becomes more comfortable with our AI solutions, we can explore the option of fully replacing the human-taught sections with our AI-powered courses. This approach maximizes savings by eliminating instructor costs entirely while providing students with 24/7 personalized instruction and verified mastery assessments. While this option may raise some faculty governance concerns, it represents a path for deeper transformation and enhanced learning experiences for students.

In conclusion, starting with the supplemental option allows Johnson & Wales University-Providence to enhance its academic offerings while maintaining existing faculty structures. The data supporting our approach is compelling either way. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss this proposal further.

Please let me know a time that works for you to connect.

Best regards,

Douglas Fong
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WHY ZHI SYSTEMS — WHAT MAKES THIS DIFFERENT

24/7 Built-In Tutors

Every student has on-demand, personalized instruction — eliminating the access gap that stalls most online learning.

Cheat-Proof by Design

Assessments cannot be gamed, so course completion actually certifies competence employers can rely on.

Industry-Aligned Progress

Advancement is benchmarked to professional standards, making the credential something hiring managers trust.

Fixed Assessments, Adaptive Lectures

Tests and homework stay locked for rigor, while lectures flex in length, depth, and style to fit each learner.

Verified Mastery

Adaptation never dilutes standards — retention and mastery are confirmed, not assumed.

5-Year Free Maintenance Guarantee

The one-time setup fee locks in five full years of platform maintenance at no additional cost — zero budget surprises.

ROI ANALYSIS

Course	Current/yr	All/yr	Saves/yr
Composition I	\$140,000	\$18,000	\$122,000
Remedial Math	\$120,000	\$18,000	\$102,000
Introduction to Psychology	\$120,000	\$18,000	\$102,000
Critical Thinking	\$112,000	\$18,000	\$94,000
Introduction to Programming	\$112,000	\$18,000	\$94,000
Ethics	\$108,000	\$18,000	\$90,000
Business Ethics	\$108,000	\$18,000	\$90,000
Data Structures and Algorithms	\$81,000	\$18,000	\$63,000
Databases / SQL	\$80,000	\$18,000	\$62,000
Total	\$981,000	\$162,000	\$819,000

MULTI-YEAR PROJECTION

Period	Cumulative Net Savings	Notes
Year 1	\$2,113,264	Annual savings minus one-time install cost
Year 2	\$4,651,528	
Year 3	\$7,189,792	
Year 5	\$12,266,320	
Based on \$2,538,264/yr savings · \$425,000 one-time install		

KEY CONTACTS

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President

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Decision power: budget

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Decision power: curriculum